

SPECIFICATIONS DOCUMENT

Applicant Tracking System (ATS) — Recruitment Process

Project: Deployment of an Applicant Tracking System to digitize the recruitment process

Requester: Human Resources Department + IT Department

Estimated Budget: €45,000 – €65,000 (3-year licenses + integration + training)

Target Deadline: Production Go-Live: Q2 2026

Scope: 3 sites, ~250 employees, 80 to 120 hires/year

1. EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Element	Description
Project	Deployment of an Applicant Tracking System (ATS) to digitize the recruitment process
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2. CONTEXT AND OBJECTIVES

2.1 Current Context

The company manages its recruitment through a heterogeneous system: shared Excel spreadsheets, individual manager emails, and an outdated careers website. The main identified pain points:

- **Lost applications:** CVs received by email are not all archived
- **Lack of traceability:** impossible to track a candidate's status in real time
- **Excessive delays:** average recruitment time of 65 days (vs. 35-day target)
- **Degraded candidate experience:** no automatic feedback, opaque process
- **GDPR non-compliance:** uncontrolled data retention

2.2 SMART Objectives

Objective	Indicator	Target
Reduce Time-to-Hire	Average recruitment time	≤ 35 days
Improve candidate experience	Post-process satisfaction rate	≥ 4.2/5
Ensure compliance	GDPR compliance rate	100%
Increase hire quality	12-month retention rate	≥ 85%
Reduce recruitment costs	Average cost per hire	-20%

3. FUNCTIONAL SCOPE (In / Out)

In Scope (IN)

- Job posting publication and multi-posting
- Automatic receipt, parsing, and archiving of applications
- Recruitment pipeline tracking (customizable steps)
- Interview management (scheduling, notifications)
- Collaborative candidate evaluation (customizable grids)
- Automated communication with candidates
- HR reporting and dashboards
- Candidate portal (application submission, tracking)
- Integration with Active Directory (SSO)
- GDPR compliance (right to erasure, limited retention)

Out of Scope (OUT)

- Payroll management (existing HRIS module)
- Training and e-learning
- Time and attendance management
- Post-signature onboarding module (phase 2 planned)

4. PERSONAS AND USER STORIES

Persona 1: HR Manager (Marie, 42)

"I waste too much time chasing managers for their candidate feedback."

ID	User Story
US-RH-01	As an HR Manager, I want to visualize in real time the progress of all ongoing recruitments, so that I can identify blockages and follow up with stakeholders.
US-RH-02	As an HR Manager, I want to receive an automatic alert if a candidate remains unanswered for more than 5 days, so that I can ensure a smooth candidate experience.
US-RH-03	As an HR Manager, I want to generate a monthly recruitment KPI report in one click, so that I can present progress to the Executive Committee.

Persona 2: Hiring Manager (Thomas, 35, IT Project Lead)

"I receive CVs by email, but I never know if someone else has already reviewed them."

ID	User Story
US-MAN-01	As a Hiring Manager, I want to view filtered applications for my position with automatic scoring, so that I can prioritize my selection time.
US-MAN-02	As a Hiring Manager, I want to enter my evaluations via a standardized grid (technical skills + soft skills), so that I can objectively compare profiles.
US-MAN-03	As a Hiring Manager, I want to schedule my interviews directly from the tool with Outlook synchronization, so as to avoid back-and-forth emails.

Persona 3: Candidate (Sophie, 28, Full-Stack Developer)

"I applied 3 weeks ago, I haven't heard anything, I don't even know if my CV was read."

ID	User Story
US-CAN-01	As a Candidate, I want to receive a personalized automatic acknowledgment of receipt, so that I know my application is properly registered.
US-CAN-02	As a Candidate, I want to access a portal to track the progress of my application, so that I am not left waiting without information.
US-CAN-03	As a Candidate, I want to be able to request the deletion of my personal data in one click, so that I can simply exercise my GDPR right.

5. DETAILED FUNCTIONAL REQUIREMENTS

Module 1: Job Posting Management

ID	Requirement	Priority	Acceptance Criteria
F-01	Job creation via customizable template	Must	≥ 5 templates available, dynamic fields
F-02	Automatic multi-posting (LinkedIn, Indeed, Welcome to the Jungle, careers website)	Must	1-click posting on ≥ 4 channels
F-03	Dedicated application URL per job	Must	Application source tracking
F-04	Job moderation before publication	Should	HR + Manager validation workflow

Module 2: Application Management

ID	Requirement	Priority	Acceptance Criteria
F-05	Automatic CV parsing (PDF, Word, LinkedIn)	Must	Recognition rate ≥ 90% on standard CVs
F-06	Structured CV database with full-text search	Must	Search by skills, experience, location
F-07	Automatic candidate scoring vs. job description	Should	Transparent algorithm, customizable criteria
F-08	Duplicate detection (same candidate, different positions)	Should	Alert if email or first+last name identical
F-09	Secure attachments (CV, cover letter, portfolio)	Must	AES-256 encryption, restricted access

Module 3: Recruitment Pipeline

ID	Requirement	Priority	Acceptance Criteria
F-10	Customizable steps per job type	Must	≥ 5 configurable steps (e.g., CV → Phone Screen → Tech Interview → Manager Interview → Offer)
F-11	Drag & drop candidate movement between steps	Must	Intuitive interface, real-time update
F-12	Comments and evaluations per step	Must	Complete history, non-modifiable
F-13	Rejection management (email template + archived reason)	Must	GDPR: limited retention to 2 years

Module 4: Communication & Collaboration

ID	Requirement	Priority	Acceptance Criteria
F-14	Customizable automatic emails (acknowledgment, rejection, follow-up)	Must	Dynamic variables (first name, position, delay)
F-15	Interview scheduling with calendar integration (Outlook/Google)	Must	Bi-directional sync, timezone management
F-16	Profile sharing between recruiters with granular rights	Should	Read-only / Comment / Edit
F-17	Push and email notifications (configurable)	Should	Per-user configuration

Module 5: Reporting & Analytics

ID	Requirement	Priority	Acceptance Criteria
F-18	Real-time dashboard (active recruitments, delays, sources)	Must	Customizable widgets, refresh ≤ 5 min
F-19	Standard exportable reports (PDF, Excel)	Must	≥ 10 pre-configured reports
F-20	Acquisition source analysis (cost/quality)	Should	ROI per recruitment channel

6. TECHNICAL REQUIREMENTS

Domain	Requirement
Hosting	Cloud SaaS (Europe preference), ISO 27001 certified hosting
Accessibility	Responsive web + mobile application (iOS/Android)
Integrations	Open REST API, native connectors: LinkedIn, Indeed, Outlook, AD/Azure AD
Security	Encryption in transit (TLS 1.3) and at rest, MFA authentication, audit logs
GDPR	DPO designated on vendor side, processing register, signed DPA, EU hosting
Performance	Response time < 2s for 95% of requests, 99.5% availability
Languages	FR interface (mandatory) + EN (desirable)
Data Export	Standard format (CSV, JSON) for reversibility

7. GOVERNANCE AND RACI

Activity	Sponsor	Business Owner (HR)	Technical Owner (IT)	Vendor	DPO
Scoping & KPI	A	R	C	I	I
Specifications Writing	I	A/R	C	I	C
Solution Selection	A	R	C	-	C
Technical Integration	I	C	A/R	R	C
Business Configuration	I	A/R	C	R	I
UAT & Acceptance	I	A	C	C	I
Training	I	A/R	C	R	I
Go/No-Go	A	R	C	I	C

Legend: R = Responsible | A = Accountable / Decides | C = Consulted | I = Informed

8. TIMELINE AND MILESTONES

Phase	Duration	Key Deliverable
T0-T1: Vendor Selection	6 weeks	Short-list, demo, final choice
T1-T2: Integration & Configuration	8 weeks	Configured environment, tested flows
T2-T3: User Acceptance Testing (UAT)	4 weeks	Signed acceptance report
T3: Training & Deployment	3 weeks	2 training sessions, user guides
T3+: Run & Support	Ongoing	SLA compliance, maintenance

9. ESTIMATED BUDGET

Item	Estimated Amount
ATS Licenses (3 years, 10 users)	€24,000
Integration & Configuration	€15,000
Training (2 sessions × 15 people)	€5,000
Change Management	€6,000
Contingency (10%)	€5,000
TOTAL	~€55,000

10. KEY CONTRACTUAL CLAUSES

- **SLA:** 99.5% availability, critical response time < 4h (L2 support)
- **GDPR:** Data Processing Agreement (DPA), listed sub-processors, EU hosting
- **Intellectual Property:** Data owned by client, explainable scoring models
- **Reversibility:** Complete data export within 30 days, no extra cost, open format
- **Penalties:** -5% monthly fee per 0.1% downtime exceeding SLA

11. RISKS AND MITIGATION

Risk	Probability	Impact	Mitigation
Change resistance (managers)	High	High	Early communication, business champions, targeted training
Insufficient CV parsing quality	Medium	Medium	POC with real sample of 100 CVs before contracting
Complex AD integration	Medium	High	Preliminary technical audit, dedicated IT contact on vendor side
GDPR non-compliance	Low	Critical	DPO validation before signing, strict contractual clause

12. APPENDICES

Appendix A — Glossary (ATS, Parsing, SSO, DPA, UAT...)

Appendix B — Sample Job Description Templates

Appendix C — Candidate Evaluation Grid (example)

Appendix D — Target Architecture Diagram (integrations)

Appendix E — Sample of 10 Test CVs for Parsing POC

Note: This specifications document is designed to be **contractual** and serve as a basis for a Request for Proposal (RFP) to ATS vendors. It can be adapted according to company size, industry sector, and HR team digital maturity.